

DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE AND DATA GOVERNANCE

RAILS, SERVICE AND SAFEGUARD → THE STACK CARD → TWO CONSENT CONSTRUCTS → LAYER-SPECIFIC RISK MATRIX → THREE-TRANCHE COMMENCEMENT → THE SECTION 44 SPLIT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00RAILS, SERVICE AND SAFEGUARD

RAILS, SERVICE AND SAFEGUARDIDENTITY, PAYMENTS, DOCUMENTS, CONSENT, COMMERCE AND HEALTH INFRASTRUCTUREA SPECIFIC DEPARTMENTAL PORTAL DELIVERED ON THOSE RAILS

THE DATA-PROTECTION STATUTE, RULES AND ENFORCING BODYWHY IT MATTERS

RAILS RAISE SYSTEMIC RISKS; A SERVICE RAISES DEPARTMENTAL ONESMUST REMEMBERDIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE SUPPLIES REUSABLE POPULATION-SCALE RAILS FOR

CORE CLAIM

- RAILS → identity, payments, documents, consent, commerce and health infrastructure
- SERVICE → a specific departmental portal delivered on those rails

MECHANISM

- SAFEGUARD → the data-protection statute, rules and enforcing body
- WHY IT MATTERS → rails raise systemic risks; a service raises departmental ones

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Digital public infrastructure supplies reusable population-scale rails for...
- RAILS → identity, payments, documents, consent, commerce and health infrastructure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Digital public infrastructure supplies reusable population-scale rails for.

01

STAGE 01THE STACK CARD

THE STACK CARDAADHAAR UNDER THE AADHAAR ACT, 2016; UIDAI; NOT PROOFUNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE OPERATED BY THE NATIONAL PAYMENTS CORPORATION

DIGILOCKER UNDER THE MINISTRY OF ELECTRONICS AND INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR REGULATED BY THE RESERVE BANK OF INDIA

COMMERCE AND HEALTH

OPEN NETWORK FOR DIGITAL COMMERCE; AYUSHMAN BHARAT DIGITAL MISSION

CORE CLAIM

- IDENTITY → Aadhaar under the Aadhaar Act, 2016; UIDAI; not proof of citizenship
- PAYMENTS → Unified Payments Interface operated by the National Payments Corporation of India

MECHANISM

- DOCUMENTS → DigiLocker under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- CONSENT → Account Aggregator regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under DEPA

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- COMMERCE AND HEALTH → Open Network for Digital Commerce; Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission
- IDENTITY → Aadhaar under the Aadhaar Act, 2016; UIDAI; not proof of citizenship

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMMERCE AND HEALTH → Open Network for Digital Commerce; Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission.

02

STAGE 02TWO CONSENT CONSTRUCTS

TWO CONSENT CONSTRUCTSACCOUNT AGGREGATORFINANCE-SPECIFIC; RESERVE BANK REGULATED; CANNOT VIEW OR STORE THE

CONSENT MANAGERGENERAL-PURPOSE REGISTRATION UNDER THE 2025 RULES; COMMENCES 13 NOVEMBER

SHARED LOGIC

GIVE, MANAGE, REVIEW AND WITHDRAW CONSENT THROUGH AN INTEROPERABLEERROR PREVENTED

CORE CLAIM

- ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR → finance-specific; Reserve Bank regulated; cannot view or store the data
- CONSENT MANAGER → general-purpose registration under the 2025 Rules; commences 13 November 2026

MECHANISM

- SHARED LOGIC → give, manage, review and withdraw consent through an interoperable platform
- ERROR PREVENTED → treating one registration as the other in a close-option question

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR → finance-specific; Reserve Bank regulated; cannot view or store the data
- CONSENT MANAGER → general-purpose registration under the 2025 Rules; commences 13 November 2026

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ERROR PREVENTED → treating one registration as the other in a close-option question.

03

STAGE 03LAYER-SPECIFIC RISK MATRIX

LAYER-SPECIFIC RISK MATRIXWHO IS EXCLUDED BY AUTHENTICATION FAILUREPAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS

WHO LACKS THE DEVICE, CONNECTIVITY OR LITERACY TO SELF-SERVE

DOES THE OPEN PROTOCOL GIVE SMALLER SELLERS GENUINELY EQUAL

IS SENSITIVE DATA WITH HIGHER RE-IDENTIFICATION RISK ADEQUATELY SAFEGUARDED

CORE CLAIM

- IDENTITY → who is excluded by authentication failure

MECHANISM

- COMMERCE → does the open protocol give smaller sellers genuinely equal visibility

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- IDENTITY → who is excluded by authentication failure

DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE AND DATA GOVERNANCE • TILE 1/4 • same master rows 0-3234 of 10902 • continues below

03

STAGE 03

LAYER-SPECIFIC RISK MATRIX

LAYER-SPECIFIC RISK MATRIX

WHO IS EXCLUDED BY AUTHENTICATION FAILURE

PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS

WHO LACKS THE DEVICE, CONNECTIVITY OR LITERACY TO SELF-SERVE

DOES THE OPEN PROTOCOL GIVE SMALLER SELLERS GENUINELY EQUAL

IS SENSITIVE DATA WITH HIGHER RE-IDENTIFICATION RISK ADEQUATELY SAFEGUARDED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
IDENTITY → who is excluded by authentication failure	COMMERCE → does the open protocol give smaller sellers genuinely equal visibility	IDENTITY → who is excluded by authentication failure
PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS → who lacks the device, connectivity or literacy to self-serve	HEALTH → is sensitive data with higher re-identification risk adequately safeguarded	PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS → who lacks the device, connectivity or literacy to self-serve

CORE CLAIM

• IDENTITY → who is excluded by authentication failure

• PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS → who lacks the device, connectivity or literacy to self-serve

MECHANISM

• COMMERCE → does the open protocol give smaller sellers genuinely equal visibility

• HEALTH → is sensitive data with higher re-identification risk adequately safeguarded

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• IDENTITY → who is excluded by authentication failure

• PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS → who lacks the device, connectivity or literacy to self-serve

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ERROR PREVENTED → treating one registration as the other in a close-option question.

04

STAGE 04

THREE-TRANCHE COMMENCEMENT

THREE-TRANCHE COMMENCEMENT

13 NOVEMBER 2025

DEFINITIONS, SECTIONS 18 TO 26 ESTABLISHING THE BOARD, SECTION 44(1) and

13 NOVEMBER 2026

SECTION 6(9) CONSENT MANAGERS AND SECTION 27(1)(D)

13 MAY 2027

SECTIONS 3 TO 5, SECTIONS 7 TO 17 RIGHTS

G.S.R. 843(E) COMMENCEMENT; G.S.R. 846(E) RULES; G.S.R. 892(E) CORRIGENDUM

13 NOVEMBER 2025 → definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, section 44(1) and

13 NOVEMBER 2026 → section 6(9) consent managers and section 27(1)(d)

13 MAY 2027 → sections 3 to 5, sections 7 to 17 rights, sections 27

NOTIFICATIONS → G.S.R. 843(E) commencement; G.S.R. 846(E) Rules; G.S.R. 892(E) corrigendum

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
13 NOVEMBER 2025 → definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, section 44(1) and 44(3)	13 MAY 2027 → sections 3 to 5, sections 7 to 17 rights, sections 27 to 34 and section 44(2)	13 NOVEMBER 2025 → definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, section 44(1) and 44(3)
13 NOVEMBER 2026 → section 6(9) consent managers and section 27(1)(d)	NOTIFICATIONS → G.S.R. 843(E) commencement; G.S.R. 846(E) Rules; G.S.R. 892(E) corrigendum	13 NOVEMBER 2026 → section 6(9) consent managers and section 27(1)(d)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NOTIFICATIONS → G.S.R. 843(E) commencement; G.S.R. 846(E) Rules; G.S.R. 892(E) corrigendum.

05

STAGE 05

THE SECTION 44 SPLIT

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SECTION 44(3)

SUBSTITUTES THE PERSONAL-INFORMATION EXEMPTION IN THE TRANSPARENCY STATUTE

IMMEDIATE TRANCHE; OPERATIVE SINCE 13 AND 14 NOVEMBER 2025

SECTION 44(2)

AMENDS THE INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY ACT, 2000

DEFERRED TO 13 MAY 2027; CHALLENGES FILED AND NO

CLOSE DISTINCTION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SECTION 44(3) → substitutes the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute	SECTION 44(2) → amends the Information Technology Act, 2000	CLOSE DISTINCTION: DPI is not every government portal, a digital identity is not...
STATUS → immediate tranche; operative since 13 and 14 November 2025	STATUS → deferred to 13 May 2027; challenges filed and no final judgment located	SECTION 44(3) → substitutes the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute

CORE CLAIM

• SECTION 44(3) → substitutes the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute

• STATUS → immediate tranche; operative since 13 and 14 November 2025

MECHANISM

• SECTION 44(2) → amends the Information Technology Act, 2000

• STATUS → deferred to 13 May 2027; challenges filed and no final judgment located

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• CLOSE DISTINCTION: DPI is not every government portal, a digital identity is not...

• SECTION 44(3) → substitutes the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: DPI is not every government portal, a digital identity is not.

06

STAGE 06

ENFORCEMENT SEQUENCE

ENFORCEMENT SEQUENCE

STAGE 1 ESTABLISHED

THE BOARD EXISTS IN LAW UNDER SECTION 18

STAGE 2 RECRUITMENT

APPLICATIONS INVITED IN MAY 2026 FOR ONE CHAIRPERSON AND

STAGE 3 PROCEDURE

RULES OF PROCEDURE AND DIGITAL-FIRST CONDUCT OF PROCEEDINGS

STAGE 4 AND 5

STAGE 1 ESTABLISHED → the Board exists in law under section 18

STAGE 2 RECRUITMENT → applications invited in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members

STAGE 3 PROCEDURE → rules of procedure and digital-first conduct of proceedings

STAGE 4 AND 5 → commenced substantive duties, then decided cases

CAUTION → no appointment order located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
STAGE 1 ESTABLISHED → the Board exists in law under section 18	STAGE 3 PROCEDURE → rules of procedure and digital-first conduct of proceedings	CAUTION → no appointment order located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off

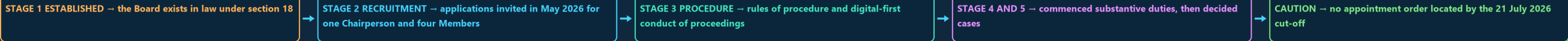
DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE AND DATA GOVERNANCE • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2556-5790 of 10902 • continues below

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: DPI is not every government portal, a digital identity is not.

06

STAGE 06 ENFORCEMENT SEQUENCE

ENFORCEMENT SEQUENCE STAGE 1 ESTABLISHED THE BOARD EXISTS IN LAW UNDER SECTION 18 STAGE 2 RECRUITMENT APPLICATIONS INVITED IN MAY 2026 FOR ONE CHAIRPERSON AND STAGE 3 PROCEDURE RULES OF PROCEDURE AND DIGITAL-FIRST CONDUCT OF PROCEEDINGS STAGE 4 AND 5



CORE CLAIM

- STAGE 1 ESTABLISHED → the Board exists in law under section 18
- STAGE 2 RECRUITMENT → applications invited in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members

MECHANISM

- STAGE 3 PROCEDURE → rules of procedure and digital-first conduct of proceedings
- STAGE 4 AND 5 → commenced substantive duties, then decided cases

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CAUTION → no appointment order located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off
- STAGE 1 ESTABLISHED → the Board exists in law under section 18

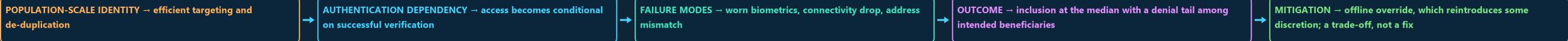
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → no appointment order located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off.

07

STAGE 07 AUTHENTICATION DEPENDENCY

AUTHENTICATION DEPENDENCY POPULATION-SCALE IDENTITY EFFICIENT TARGETING AND DE-DUPLICATION ACCESS BECOMES CONDITIONAL ON SUCCESSFUL VERIFICATION FAILURE MODES WORN BIOMETRICS, CONNECTIVITY DROP, ADDRESS MISMATCH

INCLUSION AT THE MEDIAN WITH A DENIAL TAIL AMONG OFFLINE OVERRIDE, WHICH REINTRODUCES SOME DISCRETION; A TRADE-OFF, NOT



CORE CLAIM

- POPULATION-SCALE IDENTITY → efficient targeting and de-duplication
- AUTHENTICATION DEPENDENCY → access becomes conditional on successful verification

MECHANISM

- FAILURE MODES → worn biometrics, connectivity drop, address mismatch
- OUTCOME → inclusion at the median with a denial tail among intended beneficiaries

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MITIGATION → offline override, which reintroduces some discretion; a trade-off, not a fix
- POPULATION-SCALE IDENTITY → efficient targeting and de-duplication

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MITIGATION → offline override, which reintroduces some discretion; a trade-off, not a fix.

08

STAGE 08 INTEROPERABILITY AGAINST PURPOSE LIMITATION

INTEROPERABILITY AGAINST PURPOSE LIMITATION THE SAME RAILS REUSED ACROSS MANY PUBLIC AND PRIVATE PURPOSE LIMITATION DATA COLLECTED FOR ONE PURPOSE MAY NOT BE SILENTLY GRANULAR PURPOSE-SPECIFIC CONSENT, PURPOSE TAGGING, DATA MINIMISATION PRACTICAL FAILURE

CONSENT FATIGUE, MEANING HABITUAL APPROVAL WITHOUT COMPREHENSION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
INTEROPERABILITY → the same rails reused across many public and private services	RECONCILERS → granular purpose-specific consent, purpose tagging, data minimisation	INTEROPERABILITY → the same rails reused across many public and private services
PURPOSE LIMITATION → data collected for one purpose may not be silently reused	PRACTICAL FAILURE → consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension	PURPOSE LIMITATION → data collected for one purpose may not be silently reused

CORE CLAIM

- INTEROPERABILITY → the same rails reused across many public and private services
- PURPOSE LIMITATION → data collected for one purpose may not be silently reused

MECHANISM

- RECONCILERS → granular purpose-specific consent, purpose tagging, data minimisation
- PRACTICAL FAILURE → consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- INTEROPERABILITY → the same rails reused across many public and private services
- PURPOSE LIMITATION → data collected for one purpose may not be silently reused

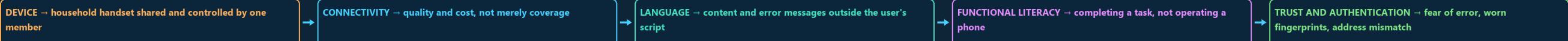
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PRACTICAL FAILURE → consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension.

09

STAGE 09 SIX BINDING CONSTRAINTS

SIX BINDING CONSTRAINTS HOUSEHOLD HANDSET SHARED AND CONTROLLED BY ONE MEMBER QUALITY AND COST, NOT MERELY COVERAGE CONTENT AND ERROR MESSAGES OUTSIDE THE USER'S SCRIPT FUNCTIONAL LITERACY COMPLETING A TASK, NOT OPERATING A PHONE TRUST AND AUTHENTICATION

FEAR OF ERROR, WORN FINGERPRINTS, ADDRESS MISMATCH



CORE CLAIM

- DEVICE → household handset shared and controlled by one member
- CONNECTIVITY → quality and cost, not merely coverage

MECHANISM

- LANGUAGE → content and error messages outside the user's script
- FUNCTIONAL LITERACY → completing a task, not operating a phone

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

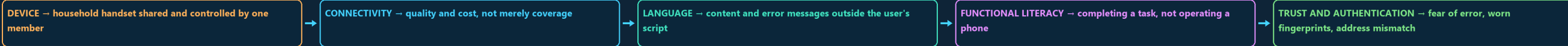
- TRUST AND AUTHENTICATION → fear of error, worn fingerprints, address mismatch
- DEVICE → household handset shared and controlled by one member

09

STAGE 09 SIX BINDING CONSTRAINTS

SIX BINDING CONSTRAINTS HOUSEHOLD HANDSET SHARED AND CONTROLLED BY ONE MEMBER QUALITY AND COST, NOT MERELY COVERAGE CONTENT AND ERROR MESSAGES OUTSIDE THE USER'S SCRIPT FUNCTIONAL LITERACY COMPLETING A TASK, NOT OPERATING A PHONE TRUST AND AUTHENTICATION

FEAR OF ERROR, WORN FINGERPRINTS, ADDRESS MISMATCH



CORE CLAIM

- DEVICE → household handset shared and controlled by one member
- CONNECTIVITY → quality and cost, not merely coverage

MECHANISM

- LANGUAGE → content and error messages outside the user's script
- FUNCTIONAL LITERACY → completing a task, not operating a phone

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TRUST AND AUTHENTICATION → fear of error, worn fingerprints, address mismatch
- DEVICE → household handset shared and controlled by one member

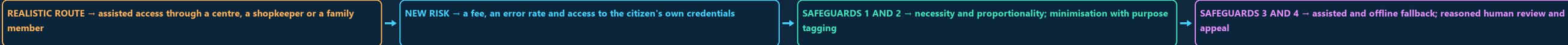
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRUST AND AUTHENTICATION → fear of error, worn fingerprints, address mismatch.

10

STAGE 10 INTERMEDIARY PARADOX AND FOUR SAFEGUARDS

INTERMEDIARY PARADOX AND FOUR SAFEGUARDS REALISTIC ROUTE ASSISTED ACCESS THROUGH A CENTRE, A SHOPKEEPER OR A NEW RISK A FEE, AN ERROR RATE AND ACCESS TO THE SAFEGUARDS 1 AND 2 NECESSITY AND PROPORTIONALITY; MINIMISATION WITH PURPOSE TAGGING

SAFEGUARDS 3 AND 4



CORE CLAIM

- REALISTIC ROUTE → assisted access through a centre, a shopkeeper or a family member
- NEW RISK → a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's own credentials

MECHANISM

- SAFEGUARDS 1 AND 2 → necessity and proportionality; minimisation with purpose tagging
- SAFEGUARDS 3 AND 4 → assisted and offline fallback; reasoned human review and appeal

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- REALISTIC ROUTE → assisted access through a centre, a shopkeeper or a family member
- NEW RISK → a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's own credentials

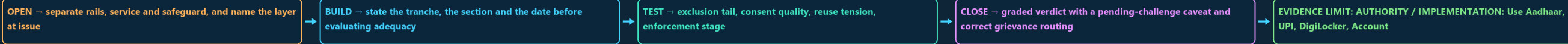
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFEGUARDS 3 AND 4 → assisted and offline fallback; reasoned human review and appeal.

11

STAGE 11 ANSWER SPINE FOR AN ADEQUACY DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR AN ADEQUACY DEMAND SEPARATE RAILS, SERVICE AND SAFEGUARD, AND NAME THE LAYER STATE THE TRANCHE, THE SECTION AND THE DATE BEFORE EXCLUSION TAIL, CONSENT QUALITY, REUSE TENSION, ENFORCEMENT STAGE

GRADED VERDICT WITH A PENDING-CHALLENGE CAVEAT AND CORRECT GRIEVANCE EVIDENCE LIMIT USE AADHAAR, UPI, DIGILOCKER, ACCOUNT



CORE CLAIM

- OPEN → separate rails, service and safeguard, and name the layer at issue
- BUILD → state the tranche, the section and the date before evaluating adequacy

MECHANISM

- TEST → exclusion tail, consent quality, reuse tension, enforcement stage
- CLOSE → graded verdict with a pending-challenge caveat and correct grievance routing

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Aadhaar, UPI, DigiLocker, Account...
- OPEN → separate rails, service and safeguard, and name the layer at issue

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict with a pending-challenge caveat and correct grievance routing.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT THE 2017 JUSTICE K.S. PUTTASWAMY JUDGMENT (A POLITY/FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS ONDC'S OPEN-PROTOCOL LOGIC EXTENDS DPI'S "RAILS, NOT PLATFORM" PHILOSOPHY ABDM'S HEALTH-DATA MODEL RAISES A DISTINCT SENSITIVITY-TIER ISSUE HEALTH DATA CARRIES

THE DIGITAL PERSONAL DATA PROTECTION RULES, 2025 WERE NOTIFIED THE DPBI WAS LEGALLY ESTABLISHED AND MEITY ADVERTISED ONE RBI'S ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR REGULATORY FRAMEWORK LONG PRECEDED THE DPDP

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- CAUTION: The 2017 Justice K.S. Puttaswamy judgment (a Polity/Fundamental Rights topic) supplies
- CAUTION: ONDC's open-protocol logic extends DPI's "rails, not platform" philosophy to commerce;
- CAUTION: ABDM's health-data model raises a distinct sensitivity-tier issue: health data carries
- The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by MeitY on 13 November

ADVANCED DEBATE

- The DPBI was legally established and MeitY advertised one Chairperson and four Member
- CAUTION: RBI's Account Aggregator regulatory framework long preceded the DPDP Act, illustrating
- CAUTION: A rural PDS beneficiary denied grain due to biometric authentication failure despite
- CAUTION: Boundary case: a Consent Manager platform that presents consent requests in dense legal

LEGACY / NUANCE

- CAUTION: ONDC enabling a small local retailer to reach buyers across platforms without
- CAUTION: Interoperability (DPI's core value proposition) and purpose limitation (DPDP's core
- CAUTION: Authentication-based service delivery improves efficiency for the majority while
- CAUTION: A legally established but not-yet-appointed Board has no case-outcome evidence.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.